Jack T. Rametta

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Academic Appointments

Postdoctoral Fellow, Ronald Reagan Presidential Foundation & Institute 2025-Present

Instructor, Inter-university Consortium for Political & Social Research, University of Michigan 2025-Present

Education

Ph.D. in Political Science, The University of California Davis 2019 - 2025

Dissertation: *The Legislative State and the Republican Revolution: A Causal Machine Learning Approach*

Committee: Christopher D. Hare (chair), Ryan Hübert, Erik J. Engstrom, Lauren Peritz, and Scott MacKenzie

Fields: American Politics and Methodology

B.A. Economics and Political Science, The George Washington University 2013 - 2016

Special Honors in Political Science & American Political Science Honors Society

Research Interests

Substantive: American political institutions, Congressional policymaking & oversight capacity, legislative support agencies, political behavior, ideology and public policy

Methods: causal inference and causal machine learning, Monte Carlo methods, predictive modeling, design-based inference, experiments, measurement, game theory, text analysis

Publications

Affect, Not Ideology: The Heterogeneous Effects of Political Cues on Policy Support
with Nicolás de la Cerda and Sam Fuller · Political Behavior, 2025 · WPSA 2023

Research under Review

Hostile Principals and The Beginning of the End of the Legislative State
MPSA 2024 · previously titled "Did the Republican Revolution Hamstring Congressional Oversight? Evidence from 55,000 GAO Reports"

Are Random Forests Still "Good Enough"? Tabular Prior-Data Fitted Networks for Predictive and Causal Tasks

How Model Choice Obscures Forecast Uncertainty: The Rashomon Effect and the 2026 Senate
with Christopher D. Hare

Leaving Money on the Table: A Monte-Carlo Study Comparing Causal Forest and Standard Regression Models for Experiments
with Sam Fuller · APSA 2025

What Predicts Support for Political Violence? Results from a Machine Learning Meta-Reanalysis
with Sam Fuller and Alexa Federice · Harvard American Politics Research Workshop 2024 · MPSA 2025 · APSA 2025

The Changing Landscape of Democratic (Dis)Satisfaction: Results from the American National Election Study 1996–2024
with Sam Fuller and Neil S. Williams · MPSA 2026

Book Project

Advanced Machine Learning for Experiments in the Social Sciences
with Christopher D. Hare and Sam Fuller · Advance contract, Cambridge Elements: Experimental Political Science · Expected 2026-2027

Causal Forest and Doubly Robust Machine Learning for Political Science
with Sam Fuller · Companion paper · MPSA 2023 · APSA 2024

Selected Research in Preparation

Populism and the Political Economy of Congressional Professionalization

ocx: Fast and Improved (Ordinal) Optimal Classification
with Christopher D. Hare, Tzu-Ping Liu, and Keith T. Poole

The Balance Permutation Test: A Machine Learning Replacement for Balance Tables
with Sam Fuller · UC Davis Political Science Research Workshop · ICPSR 2024

Rational Voting in the Age of Ideological Polarization & Responsible Parties: Examining Presidential Elections from 1972–2024
with Carlos Algara and Sam Fuller · SPSA 2026

The Dangers of Calculating Conditional Effects: A Reevaluation of Barber and Pope (2019)
with Sam Fuller · MPSA 2024

Teaching

Instructor(s) of record listed in the parentheses where applicable.

Graduate Courses

Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research at the University of Michigan

ICPSR 2025-2026: Causal Machine Learning for Observational and Experimental Data (Summer: Co-Instructor with Sam Fuller)

ICPSR 2022-2025: Machine Learning for Social Sciences (Summer: Christopher D. Hare)

The University of California, Davis

POL 213: Quantitative Analysis in Politics Science II (MLE) (S: 2022, Lauren Peritz)

POL 212: Quantitative Analysis in Political Science I (OLS) (W: 2022, Christopher D. Hare)

POL 211: Research Methods: Probability, Statistics, Design (F: 2021, Adrienne Hosek)

Undergraduate Courses

POL 109: Public Policy and the Governmental Process (S: 2024)

POL 051: The Scientific Study of Politics (Research Methods in R) (F/W: 2022-2024, Juan Tellez, McCage Griffiths, Christopher D. Hare)

POL 001: Introduction to American Politics (S: 2021 & 2023, Ben Highton & Scott MacKenzie)

POL 114: Quantitative Analysis of Political Data (Research Methods in STATA) (W: 2021, Ben Highton)

POL 110: The Strategy of Politics (Game Theory) (F: 2020, Ryan Hübert)

POL 147B: British Politics (S: 2020, James F. Adams)

POL 012A: Politics and Sports (W: 2020, Ethan Scheiner)

Software

UtopiaPlanitia: An expansive package that provides a suite functions associated with causal machine learning. This includes: causal variable importance implementations (e.g. leave-one-covariate-out (LOCO) variable importance), an omnibus suite of treatment effect heterogeneity tests, implementations of alternative curve-fitting algorithms for popular causal machine learning methods, partial dependence plots, and S3 summary/plot methods for causal forest objects from the `grf` package.

gao: A package that scrapes all publicly available Government Accountability Office published materials and returns both the original PDF/.html files as well as a cleaned dataset that extracts information from the pages. Updated daily. Associated working paper is Rametta (2026).

ocx: Extended optimal classification (ocx) is an R package for nonparametric spatial-model scaling of binary and ordinal choice data via Optimal Classification (with Christopher D. Hare, Tzu-Ping Liu, and Keith T. Poole). It unifies and extends the previous `oc` and `ooc` packages in a fully compiled, threaded C++ engine with numerous added features.

MLbalance: Implements a suite of machine learning balance tests for experimental and observational data. These tests are designed to detect failures of random assignment or covariate imbalance using machine learning and permutation inference. Associated working paper is Rametta and Fuller (2026).

2026 Senate Forecast: A live, Bayesian forecast of the 2026 U.S. Senate elections (with Christopher D. Hare). Companion working paper: Rametta and Hare (2026).

roadrunner: Fast, low-dependency implementations of classical machine learning algorithms with C++ backends via `Rcpp` and `RcppParallel`. Includes multivariate adaptive regression splines, kernel regularized least squares, penalized linear discriminant analysis, and component-wise P-spline gradient boosting, plus `meep()`, a cross-fitted stacked ensemble built for double machine learning and causal-forest nuisance estimation.

Association Meetings

Co-Organizer, Pre-APSA Conference on Democracy and Political Violence, Harvard University	2026
American Political Science Association Annual Meeting	2024, 2025, 2026
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting	2023, 2024, 2025
Southwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting	2026
Western Political Science Association Annual Meeting	2023

Discipline Service

Referee: Political Behavior, Journal of Public Policy, PS: Political Science and Policy.

Graduate Student Researcher Experience

Professor Ryan Hübert. Formal Model of Prosecutors and Discrimination. 2021

Professor Ryan Hübert. Political Appointments and Outcomes in Federal District Courts. 2020

Public Writing

"250 Years of Faction and Polarization in Congress"
Forthcoming

"Would Secrecy Make Congress Do Its Job?"
Law and Liberty, 2025

"Putting America Back On Track: A Bipartisan Approach To Fiscal Policy Solutions"
with Bill Hoagland, Shai Akabas, Jason Fichtner, and Tim Shaw · Peter G. Peterson Institute, 2019

"Debt Limit Analysis: Everything You Need to Know in 30 Slides"
with Shai Akabas and Kody Carmody · Bipartisan Policy Center, 2019

"Personnel Reform Lives, But Don't Call It 'Force Of The Future' "
with Blaise Misztal and Mary Farrell · War on the Rocks, 2018

"Supplying the Manpower America's National Security Strategy Demands"
with Blaise Misztal · U.S. Index of Military Strength Topical Essay, 2019

"Chartbook: What is the Long-Term Fiscal Outlook for the United States?"
Bipartisan Policy Center, 2018

"A Guide to the 2018 Social Security and Medicare Trustees' Reports"
with Tim Shaw · Bipartisan Policy Center, 2018

"A Preview of the 2018 Social Security and Medicare Trustees' Reports"
with Tim Shaw · Bipartisan Policy Center, 2018

"A Guide to the 2017 Social Security and Medicare Trustees' Reports"
with G. William Hoagland, Shai Akabas, and Tim Shaw · Bipartisan Policy Center, 2017

"2017 Debt Limit Analysis"
with Shai Akabas and Tim Shaw · Bipartisan Policy Center, 2017

"Building a F.A.S.T. Force: A Flexible Personnel System for a Modern Military. Recommendations from the Task Force on Defense Personnel"
Bipartisan Policy Center, 2017

"Defense Personnel Systems: The Hidden Threat to a High-Performance Force"
Bipartisan Policy Center, 2017

"The Building Blocks of a Ready Military: People, Funding, Tempo"
with Lisel Loy, Steve Bell, and Blaise Misztal · Bipartisan Policy Center, 2017

"The Military Compensation Conundrum: Rising Costs, Declining Budgets, and a Stressed Force Caught in the Middle"
with Lisel Loy, Steve Bell, and Blaise Misztal · Bipartisan Policy Center, 2017

"Chartbook: Social Security & Medicare Explained: Top 10 Questions & Answers."
with Kody Carmody · Bipartisan Policy Center, 2019

"When Will Federal Deficits Hit $1 Trillion Next? Probably Sooner than Expected"
with Steve Bell and Tim Shaw · Bipartisan Policy Center, 2017 [1]

"Harvey Raises Stakes on Debt Limit Debate"
with Shai Akabas and Tim Shaw · Bipartisan Policy Center, 2017

"The Financial Future of Social Security and Medicare"
with Tim Shaw · Bipartisan Policy Center, 2017

Other Skills

Computing: `R`, `python`, `STATA`, Mathematica, LaTeX, cluster computing

References

Christopher D. Hare (chair), Associate Professor of Political Science, University of California, Davis

Ryan Hübert, Associate Professor of Computational Social Science, Department of Methodology, London School of Economics and Political Science

Lauren Peritz, Associate Professor of Political Science, University of California, Davis

Erik J. Engstrom, Professor of Political Science, University of California, Davis

[1] For what it's worth, we were right about this.